



SIPRA DAS

The Going Gets Tough

LUCKNOW Chief Minister Mayawati's fist of steel seems to be melting. Her efforts to demolish her predecessor Mulayam Singh Yadav's projects are running into stiff resistance. The chief minister's endeavour to break down Lohia Path, a Rs 80 crore, 6 km road project initiated by Mulayam during his

tenure, ran into enraged SP workers who blocked the roads. Officials entrusted with the task beat a hasty retreat. An embarrassed Mayawati then announced that the top brass in the Government were not taken into confidence for carrying out the demolition. The eight-lane road project was meant to

NOT SO EASY: Mayawati

ensure smooth flow of traffic in Gomti Nagar.

Even earlier, when the Mayawati Government had tried to remove a statue of Rajiv Gandhi, it invited the wrath of the Congress leadership, leading her to drop the idea. Also, Mulayam's Rs 600-crore dream project of revamping his native Saifai village in Etawah district has also been put on the backburner. Reacting to Mayawati's bid to put an end to his projects, Mulayam warned her to either mend her ways or face the consequences when he returns to power. "My bulldozers will demolish your statues," he said. In the fight between the two bitter enemies, the state is clearly the loser when it comes to infrastructure.

by Subhash Mishra

Dream Ticket

DELHI Travelling in a train without a ticket invites a stiff fine and/or imprisonment or being thrown out of the train. That is for the common man, not for former Bollywood actor and BJP MP Hema Malini. In Maharashtra's Pandharpur for a show and to visit some temples, Malini was to take a train to Mumbai. However, the man assigned to hand over Malini's ticket to her at the station failed to turn up. But not having a ticket wasn't a problem for the

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Smoking in Public, R.I.P.

DELHI Union Health Minister Anbumani Ramadoss couldn't have given a better birthday gift to the father of the nation. On October 2, the complete ban on smoking in public places will come into effect under the Cigarettes and Other Tobacco Products (Prohibition of Advertisement and Regulation of Trade and Commerce, Production, Supply and Distribution) Act 2003, putting paid to smokers' urges and ensuring that non-smokers breathe a sigh of clean air. With the Supreme Court



YASBANT NEGI

PURIFYING ACT: The smoking ban is set to get real

clearing the decks for the ban, smoking will be prohibited in public places like hotels, restaurants, airports, railway stations, bars and pubs, streets and even offices. The hardest blow will be for pubs and bars, where smoking goes in tandem with drinking.

But the statistics are alarming. In India, 120 million people smoke, with 3,000 dying each day from tobacco use. Passive smoking alone causes one in eight deaths and produces six times the pollution recorded on a busy highway. by Shyam Lal Yadav

BOGEY RUN: Malini

former "dream girl". She boarded the train anyway and bumped into a rather helpful ticket collector who contacted Pandharpur, checked her ticket number and allowed her to travel on.

"News travels faster than our trains," she said. "The last time I travelled in a train was in March when I went from Delhi to Gwalior. But this time the flight and the car options were too tedious and time-consuming. I had loads of appointments in Mumbai on Friday morning and I couldn't afford the delay. But this time I had the advantage of who I am." For the dream girl, this was certainly a joyride.

by Rahul Tewari